

		PCET' S Pimpri Chinchwad College Of Engineering, Nigdi Pune Electronics & Telecommunication Student Association- ISF, IEEE SPS & IETE		
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NEXUS - 2026

PIT STOP PROTOCOL

Event Type: Non-Technical Event

Venue

3rd Floor EnTC Building

Event Coordinators

Third Year (TY) Coordinators:

Vibhuti Sahu – 8600964115

Atharva Pagrut – 9637715791

Kunj Patil – 7745898274

Second Year (SY) Coordinators:

Yash Mali – 9356800345

Vedanti Waikar – 7972037770

Prize Pool :10k

Event Description

Event Overview:

Pit Stop Protocol is a multi-round strategy and coordination event that tests participants' logical reasoning, clue-solving ability, teamwork, and composure under time pressure. Inspired by the world of Formula 1 racing, the event challenges teams to move through a qualifying assessment, a clue-driven pursuit across campus, and a final hands-on coordination challenge modelled on a race pit stop. While the theme is motorsport, every round is self-contained and logic-driven — no prior knowledge of Formula 1, its teams, or its rules is required to compete or to win. The event is designed so that participants who have never watched a race compete on equal footing with those who have.

Event Structure & Rules:

Round 1: Grid Qualifiers (Online Assessment)

- Conducted online; individual team members may attempt together on one device.
- Numerical and logical reasoning questions, lightly themed around race strategy (pit timing, lap math, probability).
- All data required to solve a question is provided within it — no outside F1 knowledge is needed.
- Teams are ranked by score, time and shortlisted for Round 2.

Round 2: Pit Lane Pursuit (Treasure Hunt)

- Each team receives an opening chit containing a hint to the location of the next clue.
- Teams follow the resulting chain of clues across the venue; each chit leads to the next.

- The final clue leads to a hidden 'suspense object' — locating and presenting it marks the hunt as complete.
- Teams are shortlisted based on the total time taken to complete the full chain.
- Each team receives a unique set of clues to prevent teams from following one another.

Optional Lifeline

- Each team may use **one additional hint** at any point during the round.
- The lifeline is **separate from the normal clue chain**.
- If the lifeline is used, **45 sec is added to the actual time**.
- **Final Time = Actual Time + 45 sec** (if lifeline is used).

Round 3 – Blindfolded Pit Walk (Final Round)

- One member of each team is blindfolded at the start line of a hurdle track.
- The track includes obstacles such as tyres, barricades, and cones laid out in a fixed pattern.
- Remaining team members stand outside the track boundary and may only guide the blindfolded member verbally — no physical contact or touching is allowed.
- The blindfolded member must complete the track, avoiding all hurdles, in the shortest possible time.
- Each hurdle contact adds a time penalty; a set number of contacts results in elimination.
- Winner is declared based on final completion time (including penalties).

Lifeline Decision

- **Use Lifeline:** Teams may call for an additional hint when stuck. **45 sec is added** to their final time.
- **Save Lifeline:** Teams may choose to solve the challenge without using the lifeline. **No time penalty** is applied, and the saved lifeline **carries into the final round as a Round 3 advantage**.

Event Timeline

Time	Activity	Description
8 October 2026 7-8pm	Round 1 – Grid Qualifiers (Online Assessment)	Online aptitude and logical-reasoning assessment, lightly themed around race strategy. All data needed to answer is provided within the questions — no prior F1 knowledge required. Teams shortlisted by score and time.
9.15 AM – 9.30 AM	Reporting & Briefing	Team verification and explanation of event rules, round structure, and safety instructions for the physical final round.
10 PM – 11PM	Round 2 – Pit Lane Pursuit (Treasure Hunt)	Chit-based clue hunt across campus. The first chit hints at the location of the second, and so on, ending in a hidden 'suspense object' that confirms completion. Teams are shortlisted by the time taken to complete the full chain.
11:00PM – 11:30 PM	Break & Transition	Break period, followed by briefing and safety walkthrough for the final round.
11.30 PM – 12:30 PM	Round 3 – Blindfolded Pit Walk (Final Round)	One blindfolded team member navigates a hurdle track (tyres, barricades, cones) guided only by verbal instructions from teammates. Winner decided by completion time and number of hurdle contacts.

Event Rules and Regulations

1. Team & Participation Rules

- Each team must consist of exactly [4] members.
- Teams must report on time for registration and briefing.
- Only registered team members are allowed to participate in subsequent rounds.
- No external help (phones, internet, books) is allowed during Rounds 1 and 2.
- Teams must follow their assigned clues strictly during Round 2; swapping or sharing clues with other teams is not permitted.
- In Round 3, only verbal guidance is allowed — no team member may touch, pull, or physically direct the blindfolded participant.
- Safety briefing for Round 3 is mandatory for all participating teams before the round begins.

2. Resource & Technical Constraints

- All necessary equipment, resources, and materials will be provided by the organizers.

3. Time & Submission Rules

- Teams must adhere strictly to the given time limits for each round.
- Teams may call for an additional hint when stuck. **45 sec is added** to their final time (ROUND 2)
- If lifeline in ROUND 2 is saved no Time penalty is added for ROUND 2 .
- Evaluation of Last Round is also Time based.

4. Conduct & Fair Play

- Teams must maintain professional behaviour throughout the event.
- Any attempt to gain unfair advantage will lead to disqualification.
- Judges' & Co-ordinators' decisions will be final and binding.

5. Disqualification Criteria & Elimination Criteria

- Any form of misconduct, cheating, or rule violation will result in immediate disqualification.
- Use of offensive, unsafe, or prohibited material.
- A time penalty is added for each contact; a set number of contacts within one attempt results in elimination. (FOR ROUND 3 HURDLES), No. of touches and exact time penalty will be conveyed at the time of Round 3.

6. Tie-Breaker Rules

- In case of a tie in ROUND 1, the team with the lower time taken in Quiz of Round 1 will be ranked higher.

Evaluation and Judging Criteria

- Accuracy of answers and solutions
- Logical approach and problem-solving strategy
- Team coordination and communication (especially in Round 3)
- Time taken to complete each round
- Rule adherence, including hurdle-contact penalties in Round 3

FAQs

1. Who can participate?

- Any undergraduate engineering student with a valid college ID.

2. Do we need prior Formula 1 knowledge?

- No. All rounds are self-contained and logic- or coordination-based; no racing knowledge is tested or assumed.

3. Can team members be changed later?

- No. Teams once registered cannot be modified.

4. Will the clues in Round 2 be the same for all teams?

- No. Each team receives a unique clue chain.

5. What happens if the blindfolded participant touches a hurdle in Round 3?

- A time penalty is added for each contact; a set number of contacts within one attempt results in elimination.